



▲ HOT SPRINGS AND TERRACES AT TERME DI SATURNIA

The Sierra Nevada

Location Andalucía, southern Spain

This domed massif of metamorphic rocks towers high above the Mediterranean and is dominated by Mulhacén, the highest peak in continental Spain, at 11,421 ft (3,481 m). Mulhacén is just one of 23 tops rising above 10,000 ft (3,000 m) in this 26-mile- (42-km-) long range. Generally, the Sierra's landforms are gentle apart from the heavily glaciated western peaks, which feature steep-sided, ice-sculpted valleys and cirques. No glaciers remain, but winter

snow makes the area a popular skiing center. With increased elevation, the vegetation on the massif's slopes changes from subtropical forest to alpine.

The Apennines

Location From the Cadibona Pass to the Egadi Islands, Italy

Among the younger chains created during the Alpine mountain-building period, the Apennines are a series of parallel ridges extending for about 870 miles (1,400 km). They are mostly made of uplifted shales,

limestones, and sandstones, with some igneous rocks, and there is plenty of evidence of volcanic activity, including the still-active Vesuvius and Etna. The only glacier here is Calderone, on the slopes of the highest peak, Corno Grande. Earthquake activity is common along the entire range.

Terme di Saturnia

Location Tuscany, Italy

These are the largest and most beautiful of southern Tuscany's hot springs. Geothermally heated

groundwater emerges at 99.5°F (37.5°C) and cascades over the waterfalls of Cascade del Mulino and Cascade del Gorello at more than 132 gallons (500 liters) per second into pools formed by the precipitation of travertine (a form of calcium carbonate) from the mineral-rich water. Despite the water's sulfurous odor, people have bathed in the pools since Roman times to take advantage of their curative properties. The groundwater is heated by hot rocks deep underground that are related to the volcanic activity at the nearby lava dome of Mount Amiata.